Public Live Viewing & Privacy Review

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Approved original policy provisions (19 October 2026)

UK Safety Camera Network Ltd

USCN-POL-005 - Public Live Viewing & Privacy Review

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Approving authority Data Protection Officer - Bertram Scanlon

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Publication status Not confirmed

Policy owner UK Safety Camera Network Ltd

1. Purpose

1.1. This policy establishes governance, privacy assessment, technical safeguards, public transparency and

incident-response requirements for public live viewing of CCTV cameras operated by UK Safety Camera Network Ltd

(USCN).

1.2. The intended general model is public access to approved live camera views where lawful, appropriate and

technically feasible. Public availability is conditional. USCN may promptly restrict, suspend or withdraw a view where

privacy, security, technical or operational concerns arise, including reasonably suspected concerns.

1.3. Public live viewing is distinct from operational CCTV recording. Authorisation to operate a camera for CCTV

purposes does not itself authorise publication of live images.

1.4. This policy operates alongside USCN-POL-001 (CCTV Operations, Privacy & Data Protection), USCN-POL-002

(Footage Access, Disclosure & Retention), USCN-POL-003 (Camera Security & Technical Safeguards),

USCN-POL-004 (Public Transparency & Accountability), USCN-LIA-001 and each camera-specific Data Protection

Impact Assessment (DPIA).

1.5. Applicable law prevails over conflicting policy provisions. Material privacy matters must be referred to the Data

Protection Officer (DPO).

2. Scope and responsibility

2.1. This policy applies to all USCN-controlled cameras for which public live viewing is proposed, configured, enabled,

restricted, suspended or withdrawn.

2.2. It applies to USCN personnel, authorised technical operators, relevant contractors and service providers involved

in public live-view delivery.

2.3. USCN retains responsibility for CCTV processing and public stream authorisation. Property hosts do not acquire

authority to publish, administer, redirect or restore streams by providing premises, power or connectivity.

2.4. The DPO reserves authority over camera-specific public live-view approval, material privacy decisions and

restoration after privacy-related suspension. Authorised personnel may take immediate precautionary protective action

without prior DPO permission.

3. Public live-viewing model

3.1. Public live viewing is the intended default model, subject to camera-specific assessment and express DPO

authorisation.

3.2. No camera may begin public live viewing merely because it has been installed, connected or configured to record.

Its DPIA, additional live-view assessment, safeguards and DPO approval must be completed first.

3.3. Public viewing will ordinarily be free, without registration, authentication or password.

3.4. Where justified, USCN may impose proportionate camera-specific restrictions, including passwords, registered

accounts, authenticated viewers, time-based access, reduced resolution or frame rate, and other appropriate limits.

3.5. Restrictions must be proportionately justified and documented. Material privacy changes or departures from an

approved live-view arrangement require DPO approval.

3.6. Public viewers must not receive administrative access, remote camera controls, operational recording access or

access to internal camera systems.

3.7. Viewing is a best-efforts service; USCN does not guarantee continuous availability.

4. Camera-specific privacy assessment and approval

4.1. Before enabling a public view, USCN must complete or update the camera-specific DPIA and separately assess

additional risks arising from public exposure of live images.

4.2. The assessment must consider the CCTV purpose and proportionality of publication; camera position, field of view

and framing; identification or singling out of people or vehicles; exposure of homes, windows, gardens or private

spaces; vulnerable people and sensitive locations; foreseeable misuse; security-sensitive activities or locations;

masking, resolution and other mitigations; separation from administration and recordings; signage and public

information; and any other material risk identified.

4.3. The DPO must expressly authorise public live viewing for each camera. Network-wide or installation

approval alone is insufficient.

4.4. Authorisation may be conditional on masking, framing, quality, access restrictions, hours or other safeguards.

4.5. If acceptable privacy and security protections cannot be achieved, public viewing must not be enabled. This does

not automatically decide whether separately authorised operational recording may continue.

4.6. Suitability must be reconsidered following relevant complaints, suspected privacy intrusion, material configuration

or contextual changes, security incidents or other information calling approval into question.

4.7. Reviews are event-triggered, not tied to a mandatory annual cycle. Prompt action is required where risk warrants

it.

5. Public-stream technical safeguards

5.1. Public-stream delivery must be logically separated from restricted camera administration and stored operational

footage.

5.2. Public access is view-only: no pan, tilt, zoom or other remote camera controls; no changes to masking, recording

or security; no searching, retrieving, exporting or deleting recordings; and no administrative credentials or internal

interfaces.

5.3. Secure delivery must minimise exposure of camera credentials, internal network details and administration

endpoints.

5.4. USCN may apply bandwidth, connection, resolution, frame-rate or other limits for privacy, security and resource

management.

5.5. A visible USCN watermark or camera identifier should appear where supported and appropriate. A watermark

does not guarantee image authenticity or prevent misuse.

5.6. Authorised personnel must have a practicable means of disabling a public stream promptly.

5.7. Faults, misuse reports and relevant alerts must be reviewed as resources reasonably permit; this is not a

guarantee of continuous monitoring.

5.8. Third-party streaming or delivery services may be used following appropriate technical/privacy assessment and

any required DPO approval. They must not provide suppliers with prohibited remote access to operational camera

systems.

5.9. Personal data processed through external delivery arrangements, including viewer-related technical data where

relevant, must be assessed under applicable data protection and supplier requirements.

5.10. Public delivery must not become cloud-based operational CCTV recording or storage contrary to

USCN-POL-003.

6. Immediate suspension and precautionary action

6.1. USCN may promptly suspend a public live view for actual or reasonably suspected concerns. Conclusive proof

is not required before precautionary action.

6.2. Triggers include suspected privacy intrusion or inappropriate identification; credible complaints; unexpected

visibility of private or sensitive locations; misuse, targeting or security-sensitive disclosure risks; failures of masking,

framing, resolution or access controls; DPO or authorised direction; and network outages or operational instability.

6.3. Authorised USCN personnel may suspend immediately without prior DPO approval when warranted.

6.4. Privacy-related suspensions and material incidents must be escalated to the DPO as soon as practicable under

relevant internal incident procedures.

6.5. Public-stream suspension does not automatically suspend operational recording. Recording ordinarily continues

under its existing authorisation unless the DPO directs otherwise or law or mandatory safeguards require different

action.

6.6. Where underlying recording may itself be unlawful or unsafe, promptly escalate; nothing in this policy requires

unlawful processing to continue.

6.7. A privacy-suspended stream must remain offline until the DPO expressly authorises restoration after

assessment and sufficient mitigation.

6.8. Ordinary technical recovery may be handled operationally where no privacy suspension or DPO restriction

remains. Automatic recovery must not override an outstanding privacy suspension.

6.9. Material suspensions and resolutions must be recorded proportionately, including reason, assessment, corrective

action and any restoration approval.

7. Public information and transparency

7.1. USCN must provide clear, accessible public live-view information through its established transparency

arrangements.

7.2. The central resource is transparency.uscn.org.uk, with camera-specific links incorporating the unique camera

ID. datahandling.uscn.org.uk may be linked where appropriate.

7.3. Camera-specific information must explain availability, purpose, nature of the view, limitations, access restrictions,

privacy safeguards, reporting routes, status where practicable, and appropriate warnings about copying, redistribution

or misuse.

7.4. USCN need not disclose detailed security architecture, internal network information or other sensitive material

where disclosure creates disproportionate risk.

7.5. Public availability does not authorise unlawful misuse of images. Notices should not falsely imply USCN can

prohibit every lawful use of publicly accessible material.

7.6. Signage and transparency information must be consistent with approved viewing arrangements and

USCN-POL-004.

8. Public concerns, complaints and privacy review

8.1. The public must have a practical route to report concerns about field of view, identification, private spaces, misuse

or inappropriate availability.

8.2. Credible concerns require prompt assessment and, where warranted, precautionary suspension before

investigation concludes.

8.3. The DPO oversees material privacy concerns, reassessment and restoration of privacy-suspended streams.

8.4. Remedies may include changed framing, masking, resolution, access restrictions, viewing hours, public

information or other controls. Viewing may remain withdrawn where mitigation is inadequate.

8.5. Complaints and statutory rights requests follow applicable law and related USCN policies. Routine enquiries are

handled proportionately within available resources.

8.6. Where practicable, provide the complainant with an acknowledgement or proportionate outcome without

disclosing confidential, personal or security-sensitive information.

9. Records and accountability

9.1. USCN must maintain proportionate records of significant public live-view decisions and actions.

9.2. Records should cover assessments and DPO approvals; material restrictions; significant complaints; material

suspensions and reasons; reassessments and corrective measures; and DPO restoration authorisations.

9.3. Every transient outage, viewer interaction or minor status change does not require a separate formal decision

record solely under this policy.

9.4. Records must be appropriately protected, access-controlled and retained in line with relevant USCN

requirements.

9.5. The DPO may review material decisions and require further mitigation, restriction, suspension or withdrawal.

10. Responsibilities and decision-making

10.1. DPO: Approves each camera's live view; reviews DPIAs and live-view risks; decides material privacy

restrictions; oversees significant complaints and reassessment; approves restoration after privacy suspension;

approves this policy and material privacy amendments.

10.2. Authorised USCN personnel: Implement approved controls; maintain separation from restricted systems;

promptly suspend where warranted; escalate significant matters; document significant decisions; and operate within

DPO authorisations.

10.3. Property hosts: Meet agreed physical, connectivity, signage and reporting duties; they may not independently

grant access, alter arrangements or restore suspended streams.

10.4. External providers: Act within approved technical and contractual arrangements. USCN retains controller

responsibility and reserved privacy decisions.

11. Mandatory safeguards and exceptions

11.1. Mandatory requirements are: (a) camera-specific DPIA and live-view assessment before enabling; (b) express

DPO authorisation for each camera; (c) immediate precautionary suspension authority for designated personnel; (d)

DPO approval before privacy-related restoration; (e) separation of public viewing from administration and recordings;

(f) camera-specific transparency and concern-reporting route; and (g) proportionate records of significant

assessments, suspensions, complaints and restorations.

11.2. Routine operational discretion cannot waive mandatory safeguards.

11.3. Operational variations in quality, access, delivery or availability are permitted within this policy and applicable

DPO authorisations. Material privacy changes require DPO approval.

11.4. If a mandatory safeguard cannot be met, public viewing must not begin or must remain suspended until

appropriately resolved.

12. Implementation and review

12.1. This policy became effective 19 October 2026 upon formal DPO approval, independently of its publication

date.

12.2. It applies to all new public live-view proposals.

12.3. Existing or planned live-view arrangements must be reviewed for compliance before being enabled or permitted

to continue; prior configuration is not an exemption.

12.4. Camera-specific approvals, public information and operational controls must be consistent with this policy before

public viewing is authorised.

12.5. Review is required when material legal, technical, operational or privacy developments warrant it; no mandatory

annual review cycle is imposed.

12.6. Material amendments affecting privacy safeguards or DPO-reserved decisions require appropriate DPO

approval.

13. Approval and document control

13.1. Formal approval: Approved by Data Protection Officer Bertram Scanlon on 19 October 2026.

13.2. Effective date: 19 October 2026, immediately upon formal approval.

13.3. Publication: Not confirmed. Formal approval and public publication are distinct events.

13.4. Next review: On material change or identified need.

End of approved policy - USCN-POL-005 version 1.0.

Integrated approved revisions — effective 20 October 2026

The following provisions form part of the current controlled policy and supersede any inconsistent earlier wording. They are not a separate draft or optional schedule.

No host access may begin until camera-specific DPIA and legitimate-interests balancing review, technical testing, written access authorisation, host terms, signage/transparency update and DPO sign-off are complete.

Separate host viewing category

Business-host viewing is a distinct, restricted use case; it is not public live viewing and does not create an entitlement for hosts generally. Start with a small pilot of eligible businesses; residential applications are deferred pending pilot review and a separate documented assessment.

Eligibility depends on demonstrated operational/public-safety benefit, restricted view of immediate frontage, assessment of pedestrians, employees, neighbours and vulnerable individuals, proportionality, privacy masking and meaningful alternatives. A camera aimed mainly at public space is not automatically low risk.

Camera-specific authorisation record

The DPO must approve separately for each camera: purpose, lawful basis and balancing test, DPIA update, exact view, viewers and roles, hours if restricted, masking, safeguards, signage/privacy notice, host undertaking, pilot duration, review date and suspension triggers.

Approval for recording does not imply approval for live host viewing; neither approval may be assumed from physical installation. USCN remains controller and determines purposes and means. Where a host uses live images for its own independent purposes, reassess controller roles and data protection duties rather than promising blanket immunity.

Pilot monitoring and exit

Maintain viewing and security event logs proportionate to risk; periodically audit access, complaints, incidents and necessity. Provide accessible complaint and opt-out routes. DPO may suspend or revoke access immediately. Evaluate the pilot before considering residential eligibility or wider rollout.